

Nigeria Artificial Intelligence Industry Collective

NIGERIA AI COLLECTIVE COMMUNITY MONTHLY DIGEST

MONTH ENDING JUNE 2026

Explore the Latest from Our Community: Key Resources, Insights, and Hot Topics in AI

This Month's Highlights:

UNESCO Launches Nigeria's AI Readiness Assessment Report

Nigeria Inaugurates AI Scaling Hub with

\$7.5m Gates Foundation Fund

Nigeria Launches Vision for a National AI Trust at London Convening

AI Summit Nigeria 2026 Convenes in Abuja Under "From Policy to Progress"

Renewed Hope-NITDA

Innovation Hub Commissioned at Obafemi Awolowo University

Bluechip Technologies Joins Anthropic's

Claude Partner Network and Acquires YarnGPT

Anthropic and Gates Foundation Commit \$200 Million to

Global Health, Education, and Agriculture

Anthropic Launches and Suspends Claude Fable 5

OpenAI

and Anthropic Both File Confidentially for IPO

Papers

Language Choice in Nigerian Social Media Hate Speech

AfriCaption: Establishing a New Paradigm for Image Captioning in African Languages

Evaluating Yoruba Text-to-Speech Systems for Accessible ComputerBased Testing in Visually Impaired Learners

Opportunities

Inclusive AI Innovations in Africa Program 2026 (AI4D / HAIDI)

Pulitzer Center AI Accountability Fellowships

SheConnects Digital Accelerator: Africa Round 2 (CARE / GSMA Foundation / Gates Foundation)

NSIA Prize for

Innovation (NPI 4.0) 2026

Accelerate Africa Startup Programme 2026 (Future Africa)

Open Startup Call for

Applications 2026

Upcoming Events

Africa Social Impact Summit (ASIS) 2026

GITEX Nigeria 2026

Immortal AI: The Retirement Party

The

Digital Nigeria International Conference & Exhibition (DNICE) 2026

ACL 2026 – 64th Annual Meeting of the

Association for Computational Linguistics

AI for Good Global Summit 2026 (ITU / UN)

ICML 2026 - International

Conference on Machine Learning

Deep Learning Indaba 2026

Thoughtful Leadership

Dr. Bosun Tijani

John Edokpolo

UNESCO Launches Nigeria's AI Readiness Assessment Report, Government Touts Best-in-Africa

Governance Ranking



Nigeria officially launched its Artificial Intelligence Readiness Assessment Methodology (RAM) Report in Abuja on 22nd June 2026, the outcome of a multi-year diagnostic exercise led by the UNESCO Abuja Office in partnership with the Federal Ministry of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy, and funded by the European Union. Described by UNESCO as the first comprehensive assessment of the country's preparedness to develop, deploy, and regulate AI in an ethical, inclusive, and human-centred way, the report has been in development since 2024 and evaluates Nigeria's standing across five critical dimensions of AI readiness, spanning infrastructure, data, policy, research, and institutional capacity.

Speaking at the unveiling, the Minister of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy, Dr Bosun Tijani, represented by Dr Bunmi Ajala, disclosed that Nigeria has climbed from 141st to 72nd place on the Government AI Readiness Index over the past three years, declaring that "in terms of AI governance, Nigeria ranks the best in Africa." The Minister credited the progress to the rollout of one of the continent's most comprehensive National Artificial Intelligence strategies, developed through a collaborative process involving researchers, entrepreneurs, policymakers, and international experts.

Officer-in-Charge of UNESCO's Abuja Office, Dimitri Sanga, framed the report not as an end in itself but as a roadmap for coordinated policy action, stressing that genuine AI readiness is measured by inclusion, access, and trust, not innovation alone. UNESCO also disclosed that it has already trained more than 400 civil servants across six Nigerian states on AI literacy under the same programme. Arriving in the same week that Minister Tijani unveiled plans for a National AI Trust in London, the report adds a second, independently verified pillar to Nigeria's case for African AI governance leadership.

Nigeria Inaugurates AI Scaling Hub, Unveils \$7.5m Gates Foundation Fund for Public Sector Innovation



Government, industry, academia, development partners, and innovators gathered at the Abuja Continental Hotel on Friday, 26th June 2026, for the official launch of the Nigeria AI Scaling Hub (NAISH) and the unveiling of the Scaling AI for Development (SAID) Challenge. NAISH is a national initiative established through a collaboration between the Federal Ministry of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy and Lagos Business School, Pan-Atlantic University, with a \$7.5 million, three-year commitment from the Gates Foundation providing technical assistance, computing infrastructure, policy support, and strategic partnerships to move Nigerian AI innovations beyond pilot projects into nationwide deployment.

Among the launch's most concrete announcements, Prof. Olayinka David-West, Dean of Lagos Business School and Director of NAISH, revealed that the Hub will procure eight NVIDIA H200 GPU compute nodes, to be hosted at Galaxy Backbone's Tier III Data Centre in Abuja, with disaster recovery support at its Tier IV facility in Kano, a tangible step towards the local computing capacity Nigeria's AI ecosystem has long lacked. She also acknowledged Data Science Nigeria's continuous technical support in shaping the Hub's operational and technical framework, placing the Nigeria AI Collective's own host organisation directly inside one of the month's most significant infrastructure announcements.

In his keynote, Minister Dr 'Bosun Tijani pointed to fintech as the one Nigerian technology sector to have achieved genuine global competitiveness, arguing that "the only technology that has been extremely successful in Nigeria is financial technology," not through brilliant founders alone but through coordinated investment across government, regulators, academia, and development partners, a model NAISH is designed to replicate for AI. The Gates Foundation's Nigeria Country Director, Uche Amaonwu, echoed the focus on measurable impact over technical sophistication. The accompanying SAID Challenge will connect clearly defined problems from Nigerian government ministries, departments, and agencies with Nigerian AI startups that have already built and validated solutions, with interested startups able to apply via naish.lbs.edu.ng. Arriving alongside the National AI Trust announcement and the UNESCO Readiness Assessment Report, NAISH adds an operational, execution-focused layer to Nigeria's June AI agenda, one in which the Nigeria AI Collective's own community now has a direct technical stake.

Nigeria Launches Vision for a National AI Trust at London Convening



Nigeria's Minister of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy, Dr Bosun Tijani, unveiled his vision for a National AI Trust at a two-day convening hosted by Warwick Business School in London on 19th June 2026, describing it as the first institution of its kind anywhere in the world.

The Trust has already been approved by Nigeria's Federal Executive Council and is designed to mobilise resources, guide responsible AI adoption, and ensure strategic, ethical AI investment across key economic sectors. The London convening, organised in partnership with pan-African innovation hub Co-Creation Hub and the US-based MacArthur Foundation, brought together senior Nigerian government representatives, international AI experts, business leaders, academics, and public interest groups to help shape the Trust's design and governance framework.

Conceived as a body of trustees rather than an operational agency, the Trust is intended to provide oversight and stewardship that outlasts any single government, with Tijani stressing that it must demonstrate impact and value to survive political transitions. The initiative sits alongside Tijani's parallel effort to raise \$2 billion for Project BRIDGE, a planned 90,000-kilometre national fibre-optic network, framing governance and physical infrastructure as two inter-dependent foundations for AI-led development.

For Nigeria's AI ecosystem, the move marks a step beyond the strategy-document stage at which most African governments remain, building directly on the five pillars of the National Artificial Intelligence Strategy launched in 2025 and signalling a deliberate, longer-term institutional bet on how the country governs AI.



AI Summit Nigeria 2026 Convenes in Abuja Under “From Policy to Progress”



Nigeria's AI Summit 2026 took place in Abuja on 16th June 2026, organised by Microsoft, the National Information Technology Development Agency (NITDA), and MTN, under the theme “From Policy to Progress: Accelerating Responsible AI Adoption for Nigeria's Digital Decade.” The gathering brought together government officials, technology executives, and policy experts to confront a problem now widely acknowledged across the ecosystem: eight major government agencies, including NIMC, the CBN, NCC, the Nigeria Immigration Service, FIRS, FRSC, CAC, and INEC, each hold valuable citizen datasets that remain siloed, with little interoperability between them.

Brought to you by:



Microsoft

AI Summit Nigeria

THEME:
From Policy to Progress
*Accelerating Responsible AI Adoption for
Nigeria's Digital Decade*



June 16
2026

PARTNER:   CONVEYED BY: 

Speaking at the event, NITDA Director-General Kashifu Inuwa Abdullahi, represented by Emmanuel Edet, said the country was ready to move from policy to progress, stressing that effective AI adoption depends on far more than algorithms alone, pointing to energy, compute capacity, data, talent, infrastructure, and trust as essential foundations.

Microsoft's Director of Government Affairs for West Africa, Nonye Ujam, echoed the call for collaborative, locally grounded approaches to building AI systems Nigerians can trust. The Summit underscored that closing Nigeria's data interoperability gap, and not simply acquiring more compute, will determine how quickly the country can translate AI strategy into measurable national impact



Renewed Hope-NITDA Innovation Hub Commissioned at Obafemi Awolowo University



The Minister of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy, Dr Bosun Tijani, commissioned a new Renewed Hope-NITDA Innovation Hub at Obafemi Awolowo University (OAU), Ile-Ife, on 8th June 2026, as part of the university's 65th anniversary celebrations. The hub houses four dedicated laboratories covering artificial intelligence, robotics, additive manufacturing, and the Internet of Things, giving students and researchers practical, hands-on infrastructure to build and test emerging technologies on campus.

OAU joins the University of Nigeria, Nsukka, and Ahmadu Bello University as host sites for similar federally backed innovation hubs. Speaking at the commissioning, Dr Tijani reminded the audience that innovation does not come from buildings, but from people, framing the hub as an investment in talent rather than infrastructure alone. For Nigeria's growing pipeline of AI researchers and builders, the addition of a third university-based hub signals a deliberate, expanding national strategy to embed AI capability directly within tertiary institutions.





Bluechip Technologies Deepens AI Capabilities: Joins Anthropic's Claude Partner Network, Acquires

Nigerian Voice AI Startup YarnGPT



ANTHROPIC

Bluechip Technologies marked a month of AI expansion in June 2026, first announcing on 5th June that it had joined the Anthropic Claude Partner Network, a vetted global ecosystem of organisations Anthropic trusts to deploy Claude responsibly inside enterprises. The listing gives Bluechip direct access to Anthropic's technical architects and Applied AI engineers for live client work, early access to new Claude capabilities ahead of general release, and structured certification from Anthropic's own teams, alongside a place in the official Claude Partner Directory.

Days later, at the third Bluechip Data and AI Summit in Lagos on 10th June, the company announced a second, complementary move: the acquisition of YarnGPT, a Nigerian text-to-speech startup founded by University of Lagos graduate Saheed Azeez, first runner-up at the Bluechip Hackathon in 2023. YarnGPT generates natural, Nigerian-accented

English speech alongside Yoruba, Igbo, and Hausa voice synthesis. Announcing the deal, Bluechip co-founder and CEO Kazeem Tewogbade framed it as a deliberate bet on homegrown language technology built specifically for Nigerian and African use cases, rather than adapted from systems designed elsewhere.

Taken together, the two announcements point to a single strategy: building deeper technical depth with a leading frontier AI lab while simultaneously investing directly in homegrown Nigerian language AI. For clients in banking, insurance, telecoms, and the public sector, the combination signals that Bluechip now has both global model access and local-language product capability to draw on, and is a reminder that the country's hackathon and startup pipeline continues to produce technology with genuine commercial value.



BREAKING NEWS

CLAUDE FABLE 5 SUSPENDED

Anthropic suspends access to Claude **Fable 5** after U.S. export-control directive.

 **Fable 5 & Mythos 5** access is currently **unavailable**.


Claude
FABLE 5

SUSPENDED

 **Government Directive**

 **Access Restricted for Foreign Users**

 **Compliance Mandatory**

 **Access Will Return as Soon as Possible**

Anthropic released Claude Fable 5 on 9th June 2026, its first publicly available model in the more advanced “Mythos” model class, alongside extensive safety testing that included more than 1,000 hours of external red-teaming and automatic routing of high-risk requests in areas such as cybersecurity and biology to a more constrained model. Within days, however, Anthropic suspended access to Fable 5, and to the unrestricted Mythos 5 model, for all users, following a directive from the United States government tied to export controls.

The episode is a reminder of how quickly access to frontier AI capability can shift for reasons entirely outside model performance or safety, a point with particular relevance for countries like Nigeria that depend on foreign-built AI infrastructure. As the conversation around data sovereignty and local compute capacity continues to grow within Nigeria’s AI ecosystem, the Fable 5 suspension adds a concrete, recent example to the argument for building more resilient, less externally dependent AI infrastructure.



Anthropic confidentially filed its draft S-1 with the US Securities and Exchange Commission on 1st June 2026, shortly after closing a \$65 billion funding round at a \$965 billion post-money valuation, briefly overtaking OpenAI's valuation for the first time. OpenAI followed exactly a week later, on 8th June, filing its own confidential registration statement at a last reported valuation of \$852 billion, with Goldman Sachs and Morgan Stanley leading the process for both companies ahead of a potential listing as early as autumn 2026.

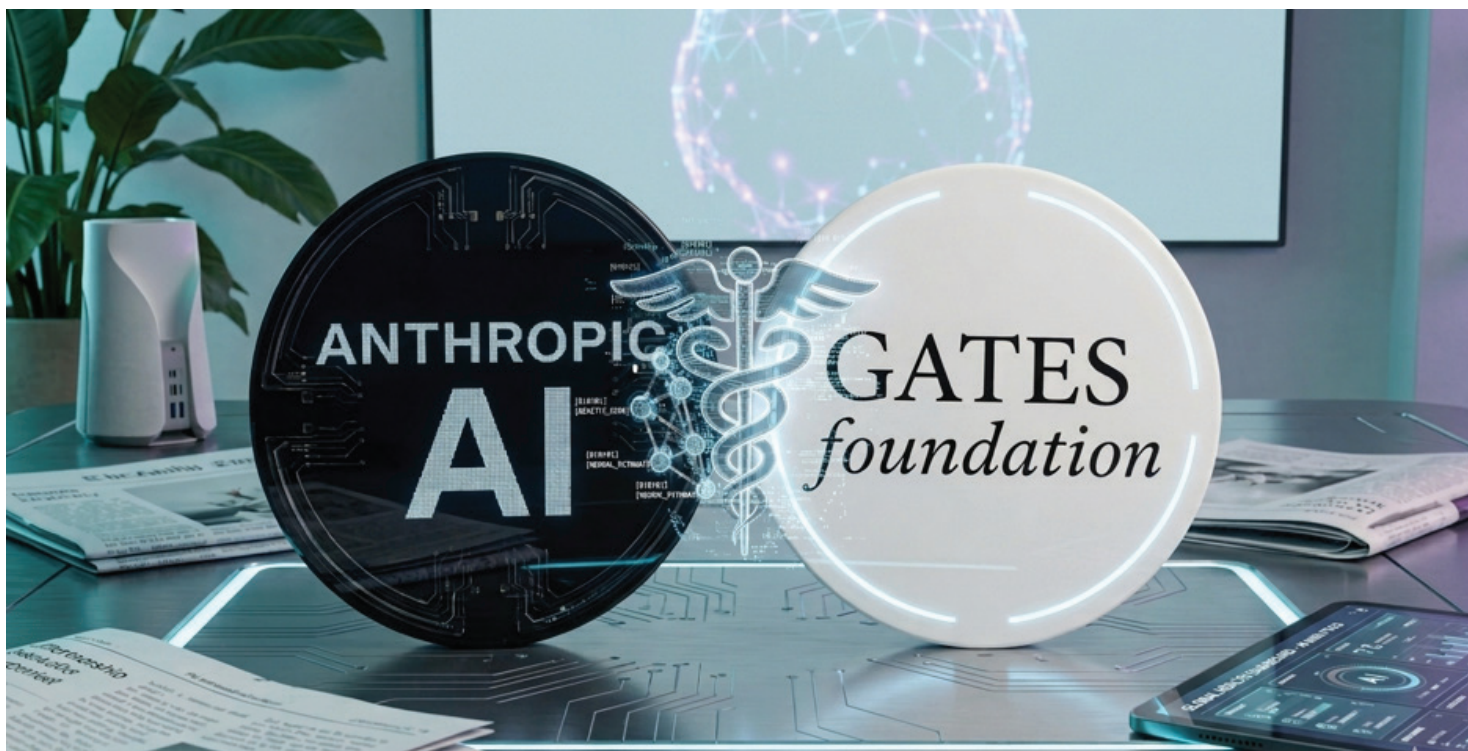
The filings follow Elon Musk's SpaceX, which priced its own IPO in mid-June at a valuation of roughly \$1.75 trillion, several times oversubscribed. Together, the three offerings form what analysts have described as an AI IPO pipeline collectively valued at well over \$3.5 trillion, a concentration of high-stakes listings markets have not seen since the dot-com era.

OpenAI said in its filing announcement that it had not decided on timing, noting it "may be a while" because

some priorities are easier to pursue as a private company, but that the filing preserves the option to go public sooner if that proves best.

For Nigeria's AI ecosystem, the near-simultaneous filings signal that the global AI industry is maturing into a publicly accountable financial asset class, with both companies set to disclose real revenue and margins for the first time. That shift carries downstream implications for how African AI startups are valued, funded, and benchmarked against international peers as investor attention increasingly follows public-market signals rather than private fundraising headlines alone.

Anthropic and the Gates Foundation Commit \$200 Million to Deploy AI in Global Health, Education, and Agriculture



Anthropic and the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation have partnered to commit \$200 million in grant funding, Claude usage credits, and technical support for programmes in global health, life sciences, education, and economic mobility over the next four years, to be implemented with partners in the US and around the world. Announced on 14th May 2026, the partnership is the Gates Foundation's largest AI commitment to date and Anthropic's most significant non-commercial deployment of Claude.

In healthcare, the partnership will support work on vaccines for polio and HPV, therapies for preeclampsia, and an integration with the Institute for Disease Modeling to improve forecasts for diseases like malaria and tuberculosis — including making those forecasts more accessible to practitioners who are not modelling specialists. In education, the work focuses on AI-powered tutoring for K-12 students in the US, and foundational literacy and numeracy tools in sub-Saharan Africa and India, developed through the Global AI for Learning Alliance (GAILA).

Critically for the Nigerian ecosystem, datasets and benchmarks built under the programme, including African-language data and smallholder agriculture datasets — will be released as public goods, freely available to governments, researchers, and developers. For teams building agricultural or health AI tools for Nigerian and African contexts, this infrastructure layer represents a meaningful shift in what is possible without starting from scratch.

Home-grown Research with Global Recognition

Papers: [Language Choice in Nigerian Social Media Hate Speech](#)

Authors: Nneoma C. Udeze, Rob Voigt

Venue: Proceedings of the 7th Workshop on African Natural Language Processing (AfricaNLP 2026), held alongside EACL 2026, Rabat, Morocco.

Nigeria's online spaces are built on a complex mix of English, Nigerian Pidgin, Yoruba, Hausa, Igbo, and other languages, and people do not switch between them at random. This paper asks a question with significant real-world stakes: when harmful or hateful content appears on Nigerian social media, which language is it written in, and does the choice of language tell us something about who is being targeted and how?

The researchers conducted the first systematic analysis of Nigerian Pidgin in online hate speech across two platforms; Twitter and Instagram, using a detailed annotation scheme that labelled each post by type of harm, targeted group, language variety, and hate strategy.

Their findings show that Nigerian Pidgin is disproportionately used in offensive and hateful discourse, particularly in attacks against Hausa people, women, and LGBTQ+ groups, and that insults are the dominant form of hate expression. The study also found that AI classifiers trained on Twitter data significantly over-predict hate speech when applied to Instagram content — a warning sign for anyone building content-moderation tools that assume platforms behave the same way.

For the Nigeria AI ecosystem, this paper has direct implications. It offers a rigorous dataset and framework for researchers, content-trust teams, and policy advocates working on responsible social media governance, and it surfaces a structural challenge for AI safety tooling in the Nigerian context: the same model trained in one environment may cause real harm if deployed uncritically in another.

Papers: [AfriCaption: Establishing a New Paradigm for Image Captioning in African Languages](#)

Authors: Mardiyah Oduwole, Prince Mireku, Fatimo Adebajo, Oluwatosin Olajide, Mahi Aminu Aliyu (Abubakar Tafawa Balewa University), Jekaterina Novikova

Venue: Proceedings of the 7th Workshop on African Natural Language Processing (AfricaNLP 2026), held alongside EACL 2026, Rabat, Morocco

Most AI vision systems, the kind that describe images, power accessibility tools, or support visual search, were built to work in English or a handful of European languages. When they encounter an image, they can describe what they see, but only in those languages. For the vast majority of African-language speakers, this capability simply does not exist.

This paper presents AfriCaption, a comprehensive framework for multilingual image captioning across 20 African languages, with three core contributions: a curated dataset built on Flickr8k featuring semantically aligned captions generated through a context-aware selection and translation process; a dynamic quality-preservation pipeline using model ensembling and adaptive substitution; and the AfriCaption model itself, a 0.5 billion parameter vision-to-text architecture that integrates SigLIP and NLLB200 to generate captions across under-represented languages. The

Home-grown Research with Global Recognition

dataset covers Igbo, Hausa, Yoruba, and 17 other languages spanning Afro-Asiatic, Niger-Congo, and Nilo-Saharan families.

The paper is co-authored by Nigerian researchers affiliated with ML Collective Africa and Abubakar Tafawa Balewa University. For Nigeria's AI product builders, it offers both a usable resource and a replicable pipeline for building image-understanding tools that actually work in Nigerian languages, a foundational step toward AI products that feel native to African users rather than translated afterthoughts.

Papers: [Evaluating Yoruba Text-to-Speech Systems for Accessible Computer-Based Testing in Visually Impaired Learners](#)

Authors: Kausar Yetunde Moshood, Victor Tolulope Olufemi, Oreoluwa Boluwatife Babatunde, Emmanuel Bolarinwa, Williams Oluwademilade

Venue: Proceedings of the 7th Workshop on African Natural Language Processing (AfricaNLP 2026), held alongside EACL 2026, Rabat, Morocco

For a visually impaired student in Nigeria preparing for a computer-based examination, one critical question is whether the technology can actually read the questions aloud in a language they understand well. This paper investigates exactly that — evaluating how well current text-to-speech (TTS) systems perform in Yoruba for learners with visual impairments sitting computer-based tests.

The research team, all based in Nigeria, tested existing TTS systems against the specific demands of exam content in Yoruba, measuring not just pronunciation accuracy but intelligibility, naturalness, and suitability for an educational setting. The work highlights persistent gaps between what commercial TTS systems can do in English and what is currently available in Yoruba, and proposes directions for closing that gap through better evaluation standards and targeted model development.

For the ecosystem, this paper sits at an important intersection of AI accessibility, inclusive education, and language technology — areas where Nigeria has significant unmet need and real opportunity to lead. It is also a clear signal that Nigerian researchers are increasingly moving from observing gaps to rigorously measuring and proposing solutions to them.

Opportunities and Events

An overview of upcoming events, available funding, proposal invitations, and other timely opportunities shared within the Community.

Inclusive AI Innovations in Africa Program 2026 (AI4D / HAIDI)



Hub for AI and
Disability Inclusion



CALL FOR APPLICATIONS

Inclusive AI Innovations in Africa

Scale your AI Solutions for Persons with Disabilities

KES 5,000,000
Grant per venture (or USD equivalent)

Venture Building Support
18 months of support and linkages to strategic networks.

TOP
3 Ventures
TO BE
SELECTED

PRIORITY SECTORS



Education



Employment



Mental Health



Caregiving &
Independence



Other Assistive
Technology

WHO SHOULD APPLY

- Post-MVP or market-ready AI ventures
- Serving persons with disabilities or caregivers
- Demonstrated real user validation
- Legally registered and operating in Africa
- Commitment to safeguarding, responsible AI, and data protection

PROGRAM TIMELINE

APPLICATIONS CLOSE: 17 July 2026

Shortlist & Interviews: August 2026

Cohort Announced & Program Begins: September 2026



Scan to apply

Questions/information
communication@at4d.org



Opportunities and Events

Deadline – 17th July 2026

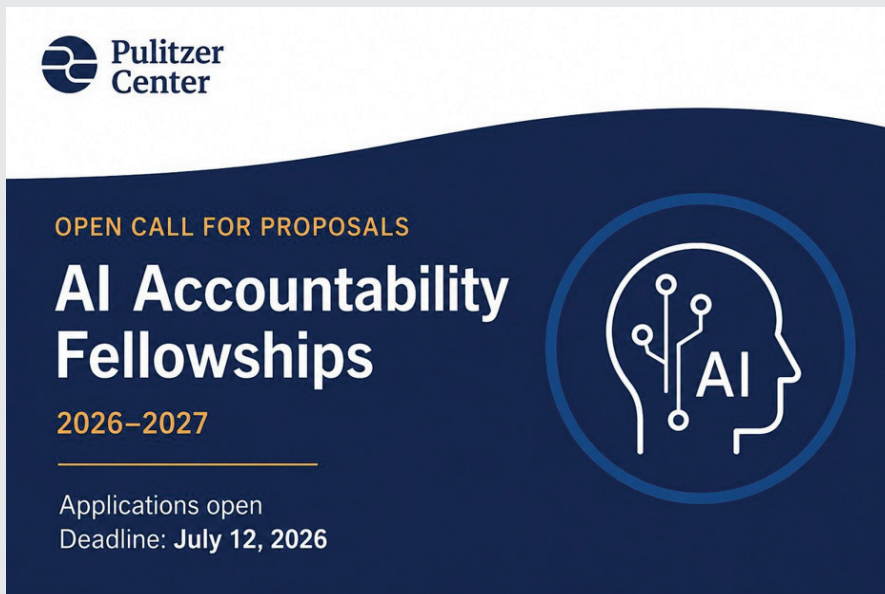
[Inclusive AI Innovations in Africa Program 2026 \(AI4D / HAIDI\)](#)

The Hub for AI and Disability Inclusion (HAIDI), under the AI4D Africa programme, has opened applications for its Inclusive AI Innovations in Africa Program 2026, offering grants of up to KES 5,000,000 (\$38,635.00 USD or ₦52,802,070.46 NGN) to support AI solutions that advance disability inclusion across the continent.

The call is open to startups and SMEs, individual innovators and researchers, research institutions, and multi-stakeholder consortia, with a particular focus on solutions that have moved beyond the prototype stage and are ready to scale.

Nigerian innovators building assistive technology, accessible AI interfaces, or disability-inclusive digital services are well placed to apply, particularly given the programme's emphasis on solutions already validated beyond the MVP stage.

Pulitzer Center AI Accountability Fellowships 2026-2027

The poster features the Pulitzer Center logo at the top left. Below it, the text 'OPEN CALL FOR PROPOSALS' is in orange. The main title 'AI Accountability Fellowships' is in large white font, followed by '2026-2027' in orange. To the right is a circular graphic with a white outline of a head containing circuit lines and the letters 'AI'. At the bottom left, it says 'Applications open' and 'Deadline: July 12, 2026' in white.

Pulitzer Center

OPEN CALL FOR PROPOSALS

AI Accountability Fellowships

2026-2027

Applications open
Deadline: July 12, 2026

Deadline – 17th July 2026

[Pulitzer Center AI Accountability Fellowships 2026-2027](#)

The Pulitzer Center has opened applications for the fifth cohort of its AI Accountability Fellowships, a ten-month programme for journalists and media professionals beginning in September 2026. Fellows receive support to produce in-depth reporting examining how AI systems are being deployed across sectors such as policing, medicine, social welfare, criminal justice, and hiring.

For Nigerian journalists and media professionals already engaged in AI accountability work through the Nigeria AI Collective's CSOs Community of Practice, the fellowship offers a structured route to deepen and fund that reporting over a sustained period.

Opportunities and Events

SheConnects Digital Accelerator: Africa Round 2 (CARE / GSMA Foundation / Gates Foundation)

A graphic for the SheConnects Digital Accelerator 2026 funding call. It features a dark teal background with a stylized illustration of a person with dark hair and a yellow shirt, holding a white tablet with a blue and green interface. To the right of the person is a large white rounded rectangle containing four horizontal bars in teal, yellow, green, and purple. The text is white and yellow, providing key details about the funding call.

FUNDING CALL

SheConnects Digital Accelerator 2026

Funding for women-centred digital solutions across Sub-Saharan Africa

USD 500K - USD 1M
18-month implementation grants

Apply by 8 July 2026

Deadline – 8th July 2026

[SheConnects Digital Accelerator: Africa Round 2 \(CARE / GSMA Foundation / Gates Foundation\)](#)

The SheConnects Digital Accelerator: Africa has officially launched its Request for Applications for Accelerator Round 2, inviting organisations across Sub-Saharan Africa to compete for awards ranging from USD \$500,000 to \$1,000,000 over an 18-month implementation period. The initiative is designed to support high-impact digital solutions that strengthen women's participation in health, education, and agriculture-linked livelihoods, with a projected reach of more than 50,000 women users.

The programme is managed by CARE and the GSMA Foundation with support from the Gates Foundation. Notably, Nigerian organisations have already featured in Round 1 — the Centre for Information Technology and Development (CITAD) and TechHer were among the four African organisations selected. This Round 2 call explicitly welcomes consortium or partnership applications, which widens the door for Nigerian AI startups, NGOs, and research organisations to apply collaboratively.

Eligible organisations must be registered non-profits, NGOs, social enterprises, or private sector entities government agencies and multilateral organisations are explicitly excluded as lead applicants.

Opportunities and Events

NSIA Prize for Innovation (NPI 4.0) 2026



The poster features three individuals representing different sectors: a man in a factory setting for Manufacturing, a woman in medical scrubs for Healthcare, and a man in overalls holding a basket of vegetables for Climate & Food Security. The background is a bright, sunlit interior with large windows.

Ignite your Startup Potential

Here's your opportunity to win a combined prize value of up to **\$275K** comprising the **\$220K** NSIA Prize for Innovation, **\$45K** Cascador Prize for Impact, and the **\$10K** Wema Bank Enterprise Award, alongside a fully funded training programme at Enterprise Development Centre. Additionally, participants stand a chance to secure between **\$500K** to **\$1.5M** from the Pula Xcelerator

Visit: nsia-ip.com to apply // Portal open June 8th - July 8th, 2026

Entries are open to startups in Healthcare, Manufacturing and Climate & Food Security only

PARTNERS

Logos for partners: NSIA, CASCADOR, WEMA BANK, PULA, and ENTERPRISE DEVELOPMENT CENTRE.

Terms and conditions apply

Deadline – Open until July 8, 2026

[NSIA Prize for Innovation \(NPI 4.0\) 2026](#)

The NSIA Prize for Innovation (NPI 4.0) is an initiative of the Nigeria Sovereign Investment Authority that supports early-stage startups developing technology-driven solutions to address challenges in sectors such as healthcare, agriculture, climate, and manufacturing. The programme provides funding, mentorship, and accelerator support to help startups scale their ideas and connect with investors.

Selected startups will advance through a competitive selection process, culminating in a demo day where finalists pitch for funding and investment opportunities.

Opportunities and Events

Accelerate Africa Startup Programme 2026 (Future Africa)



The poster features a green and white color scheme. At the top, the word 'ACCELERATE' is in large, bold, black letters, with a green arrow pointing upwards through the 'A'. Below it, 'AFRICA' is in smaller, black, spaced-out letters. A dark green banner with 'STARTUP PROGRAMME' in white text is positioned below 'AFRICA'. The words 'NOW OPEN' are prominently displayed in large, bold, black letters. Below this, a white box with a green border contains the text 'FUNDING \$250K – \$500K FOR STANDOUT STARTUPS'. Underneath the funding box, there are seven circular icons representing different sectors: AGTECH (a plant), FINTECH (a smartphone with a dollar sign), CLIMATE TECH (a globe with a leaf), LOGISTICS (a truck), HEALTHTECH (a heart with a pulse line), AI (a brain with circuitry), and DIGITAL PLATFORMS (a computer monitor with a grid). Below these icons, a white box with a green border contains a calendar icon and the text 'DEADLINE 25TH JULY 2026'. At the bottom, a dark green banner features a globe icon, the text 'APPLY HERE', and the website 'acceler8.africa'.

ACCELERATE
AFRICA
STARTUP PROGRAMME
NOW OPEN

FUNDING
\$250K – \$500K
FOR STANDOUT STARTUPS

AGTECH FINTECH CLIMATE TECH LOGISTICS HEALTHTECH AI DIGITAL PLATFORMS

DEADLINE
25TH JULY 2026

APPLY HERE | acceler8.africa

Deadline – 25th July 2026

[Accelerate Africa Startup Programme 2026 \(Future Africa\)](#)

The Accelerate Africa Startup Programme 2026 is now accepting applications from early-stage founders building global businesses that solve Africa's biggest challenges. The 12-week programme selects only 10 founders and provides focused support across five critical areas: storytelling, people and operations, go-to-market strategy, financial growth, and fundraising.

Beyond the programme, the Future Africa fund may invest a pre-seed or seed stage cheque of \$250,000 to \$500,000 in selected startups following the standard due diligence and investment committee process. A co-founder is required to apply, with a preference for teams that include a female founder.

There is no application fee and no equity required to apply to the programme itself. For Nigerian AI founders at the early stage who are thinking globally, this is one of the most credible and well-networked pan-African accelerators currently running.

Opportunities and Events

Open Startup Call for Applications 2026



The poster features a dark blue background with a faint map of Africa. At the top left, it says 'Pan-African Acceleration Platform'. At the top right, it says 'Open Startup International' with a logo that includes a stylized 'ST' and a globe. The main title 'OPEN STARTUP CALL FOR STARTUP APPLICATIONS 2026' is in large, bold, white and blue letters. Below the title, it says 'For African **DeepTch** and **Tech ventures** building high-impact solutions for Africa in: Climate, Health, AI & more..'. There are two main sections: '1 PRE-SEED TRACK' for early-stage ventures and '2 SEED TRACK' for startups ready to scale. At the bottom, it says 'One acceleration platform, two startup tracks, clearer pathways, better support.' and lists various partner logos including AfricaGrow, AFRICINVEST, STEELBOSCH, CERI, SWEAT AFRICA, STEVE MADDEN, MIT Africa, COLUMBIA ENGINEERING, and bpi france.

Pan-African Acceleration Platform

Open Startup International **ST**

OPEN STARTUP CALL FOR STARTUP APPLICATIONS 2026

For African **DeepTch** and **Tech ventures** building high-impact solutions for Africa in: Climate, Health, AI & more..

1 PRE-SEED TRACK

For early-stage ventures building and validating their solution.

2 SEED TRACK

For startups ready to scale traction and accelerate growth.

One acceleration platform, two startup tracks, clearer pathways, better support.

Partners: AfricaGrow, AFRICINVEST, STEELBOSCH, CERI, SWEAT AFRICA, STEVE MADDEN, MIT Africa, COLUMBIA ENGINEERING, bpi france.

Deadline – 31st July 2026

[Open Startup Call for Applications 2026](#)

Open Startup is now accepting applications from Tech and DeepTech ventures building high-impact solutions to critical challenges across Africa. The programme runs two dedicated tracks: the **Pre-Seed Track**, for early-stage ventures still building and validating their solution, and the **Seed Track**, for startups ready to scale traction and accelerate growth.

Eligible sectors span Climate (AgriTech, CleanTech, Renewable Energy, WaterTech), Health (HealthTech, MedTech, BioTech, Diagnostics, Telemedicine), AI and Emerging Technologies (AI, Robotics, SaaS), and other

Opportunities and Events

high-impact areas including FinTech, EdTech, and Logistics and Supply Chain.

Selected startups benefit from a regional training bootcamp to strengthen growth and investment readiness; tailored mentorship adapted to their stage and sector; international exposure across African and global ecosystems; investor and corporate matchmaking; access to talent and technical fellowships; investment tickets of between \$20,000 and \$50,000 USD; and membership of a pan-African community of founders, mentors, investors, and ecosystem builders.

One important note for applicants: participation comes with a 1% mission-aligned give-back mechanism, implemented via a SWEAT SAFE note issued to an investment vehicle dedicated to the long-term sustainability of Open Startup's ecosystem-building efforts. Any proceeds from future liquidity events are reinvested directly into the programme's mission. Founders should factor this into their decision before applying.

An Info Session takes place on **7th July 2026** — register to attend before applying.

- Apply (Pre-Seed Track): <https://lnkd.in/dkAPCYSN>
- Apply (Seed Track): <https://lnkd.in/dEAbQb9B>
- Info Session (7th July): <https://lnkd.in/duMp8zrj>
- Application Booklet: <https://lnkd.in/dsxp7-ak>
- Learn more: <https://open-startup.org/>

Upcoming Events

An overview of upcoming events, available funding, proposal invitations, and other timely opportunities shared within the Community.

1. Africa Social Impact Summit (ASIS) 2026

Date: 22nd - 23rd July 2026

Location: Eko Convention Centre, Lagos, Nigeria (In-person)

Convened by the Sterling One Foundation in partnership with the United Nations in Nigeria and the Federal Ministry of Budget and National Planning, the Africa Social Impact Summit returns under the theme "Financing for Development: Building Resilience and Transforming Emerging Economies."

The Summit is expected to draw more than 2,000 delegates from over 50 countries, with sessions spanning development finance, technology, and social impact, including AI's growing role in each



2. GITEX Nigeria 2026

Date: 7th-10th September 2026

Location: Abuja and Lagos, Nigeria

GITEX returns to Nigeria for a multi-city edition spanning a Government Leadership and AI Summit in Abuja on 7th September, followed by a Tech Expo, Future Economy Conference, and Startup Festival across Lagos venues from 9th to 10th September.

Held under the patronage of President Bola Ahmed Tinubu, the event is expected to bring together government leaders, global technology firms, and Nigeria's startup ecosystem to showcase the country's growing digital and AI ambitions.

Upcoming Events

3. Immortal AI: The Retirement Party

Date: 17th July 2026, 3:30 PM – 8:00 PM

Location: Civic Centre, Victoria Island, Lagos, Nigeria

Immortal AI is hosting "The Retirement Party," an event for data analysts, finance leaders, business owners, and data enthusiasts marking the shift away from traditional, manually built dashboards in business intelligence. The framing draws on Microsoft's planned retirement of Power BI Q&A in December 2026, using it as a starting point to showcase Immortal BI, a tool the company positions as turning raw data directly into narrative-style insights without manual dashboard-building.

The evening will include live AI demonstrations, panel-style discussions on the future of data intelligence in Africa, and structured networking for attendees working across data and finance functions. Registration is free but capacity-limited.



networking, exhibitions, innovation showcases, and strategic collaborations across Africa's growing digital ecosystem

4. The Digital Nigeria International Conference & Exhibition (DNICE) 2026

Date: 11th – 13th August, 2026

Location: Bola Ahmed Tinubu International Conference Center (BATICC) in Abuja, Nigeria

The Digital Nigeria International Conference & Exhibition (DNICE) 2026 is Africa's premier technology event, hosted by the National Information Technology Development Agency.

This year's edition moves from strategy to execution, focusing on practical delivery within the digital economy. The three-day event will bring together policymakers, global tech leaders, innovators, and industry stakeholders to explore advancements in artificial intelligence, blockchain, cybersecurity, and digital inclusion.

DNICE 2026 will also provide opportunities for

Upcoming Events

5. ACL 2026 – 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics

Date: 2nd – 7th July 2026

Location: Grand Hyatt Manchester, San Diego, California, USA (Hybrid – In-person + Virtual)

The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics will take place in San Diego, California, from 2nd–7th July 2026. ACL is the world's premier conference on natural language processing and computational linguistics, and one of the most directly relevant global venues for Nigerian researchers working on African languages, machine translation, speech recognition, and large language models. The conference runs as a hybrid event, meaning Nigerian researchers and practitioners can participate virtually for key sessions. For those who have submitted work or are active in NLP research, this is a key date to engage with the global community.

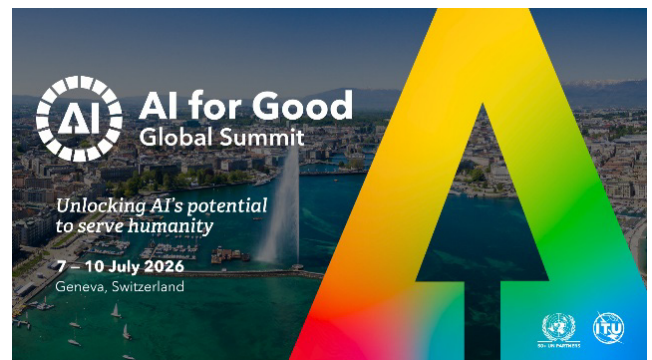


6. AI for Good Global Summit 2026 (ITU / UN)

Date: 7th – 10th July 2026

Location: Palexpo Convention Centre, Geneva, Switzerland (In-person + Remote Streaming)

The AI for Good Global Summit returns to Geneva for its seventh edition, organised by the International Telecommunication Union (ITU) alongside dozens of UN agencies and supported by the Government of Switzerland. Across three stages, the Summit features keynotes, expert discussions, workshops, and live demonstrations exploring how AI is shaping the future of work, advancing healthcare, transforming creativity and culture, supporting education and skills development, and opening new perspectives on longevity. Open to all visitors, the Summit brings together policymakers, industry leaders, researchers, innovators, artists, and youth from around the world. Participants can choose to attend either physically in



Geneva or watch sessions on the Centre Stage remotely. The inaugural Global Dialogue on AI Governance, established under a UN General Assembly Resolution, will be held back-to-back with the Summit.

The 2026 edition introduces a paid registration model for in-person attendance. Nigerian attendees requiring visa support letters should note the 9 June 2026 deadline for ITU member approval.

Upcoming Events



are available, covering registration and hotel for in-person attendance, or a virtual pass for remote participants — those who register before the deadline and are awarded aid will be refunded. Accepted papers and talk recordings are made publicly available after the event for those unable to travel.

7. ICML 2026 - International Conference on Machine Learning

Date: 6th - 11th July 2026

Location: Seoul, South Korea (In-person)

The 43rd edition of the International Conference on Machine Learning remains one of the world's most prestigious AI research venues. Globally renowned for presenting cutting-edge research across machine learning, AI, statistics, data science, machine vision, computational biology, speech recognition, and robotics, it is a key reference point for anyone serious about the direction of the field. This year, 6,352 papers were accepted from 23,918 submissions, a 26.6% acceptance rate. The programme runs July 6 (Expo & Tutorials), July 7-9 (Main Conference), and July 10-11 (Workshops).

Nigerian researchers with accepted papers and community members wishing to attend as delegates can register at the official website. Financial aid grants

8. Deep Learning Indaba 2026

Date: 7th - 10th July 2026

Location: Pan-Atlantic University (PAU), Lagos, Nigeria

The 2026 edition of the Deep Learning Indaba takes place 2nd-7th August in Lagos, Nigeria, centred on the theme of Sovereign Intelligence: Africa's capacity to develop and direct its own AI systems, data, and scientific future. The programme will feature keynotes, tutorials, workshops, practical sessions, research presentations, and community discussions, all designed to showcase the depth and diversity of African machine learning and to strengthen the AI community. Applications to participate are now open.

This is Africa's premier annual AI gathering and will be hosted in Nigeria for the first time. A landmark moment for the Nigeria AI ecosystem.



Thought Leadership



Dr. Bosun Tijani

(Minister of Communications, Innovation & Digital Economy, Nigeria)

At the National AI Trust Convening, Warwick Business School, London, 19th June 2026.

Unveiling Nigeria's plan for a National AI Trust, already approved by the Federal Executive Council, Tijani argued that the institution's survival depends less on the strength of its mandate than on its ability to outlast the political cycle that created it. The Trust is designed as a body of trustees rather than a government agency, intended to mobilise resources and steer ethical AI investment in a way that persists across successive administrations. For Tijani, that durability begins with a single principle: "The competitiveness of any society starts with governance."

Read more: [Guardian News](#)



John Edokpolo

(Head of Legal Affairs for Africa, Microsoft)

At AI Summit Nigeria 2026, Abuja, 16th June 2026.

Speaking on the panel that examined Nigeria's siloed government data systems, Edokpolo challenged the assumption that AI leadership belongs only to nations building frontier models. Pointing to the UAE and Singapore as reference points, he argued that their advantage came from a different, more achievable kind of investment: centralising and digitising the machinery of government itself so that data can move and AI can actually be deployed against it.

"These countries are not necessarily leading in chip design or model development."

Read more: [Techcabal](#)

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